

Natural History





About the Course

Students learn methodically about the variety of creatures around them, including insects, birds, and reptiles. Coordinating afternoon activities are provided in Outdoor Work.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Grade 3

About Science: Grade 3

In level 3, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and more abstract concepts.

Science: Grade 3

The Big Picture:

To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Literature Grades 1-3).



Placement & Combining Tips

About Science: Grade 3

In level 3, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and more abstract concepts.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3	Natural History: Grade 3 1 time/week 10 min	Christian Liberty Nature Reader Book 4

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Grade 3				
General Science: Grade 3 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	Nature Notebook: Grade 3	Natural History: Grade 3		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Science: Grade 3

- ☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
- ☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:

- ☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
- ☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Special Topics & Field Trips

Science: Grade 3

- ☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
- ☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

Natural History: Grade 3

- ☐ Term 1: insects and birds
- ☐ Term 2: birds and trees
- ☐ Term 3: turtles, fish, birds, tree buds, includes special excursions to a pond and a natural history museum

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Science: Grade 3

Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

Natural History: Grade 3

- ☐ Term 1: moths p.310-328
- ☐ Term 2: crows p.124-127
- ☐ Term 3: turtles p.204-210



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Natural History: Grade 3



Christian Liberty Nature Reader Book 4



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Natural History: Grade 3

How To Teach



Introduce

- Begin each lesson with learners' existing knowledge. If the book or activity is new or unfamiliar, then look at the title, a picture, or guidance in the lesson plan to help discuss what students think, drawing on previous experience. If continuing or revisiting a topic or activity, then recap. The lesson plans often help with this.
- Some learners may benefit from using pictures or looking back briefly.
- Allow them time to share any concerns and come alongside, as needed.



Complete

- Read, or do, as instructed in the lessons, noting any Teacher Tips provided. Learners should always have their nature journal or some other notebook/paper available in case they need to draw or diagram during the lesson.
- When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try to show them with a picture or connect the idea to something they have seen in real life. They are learning much by the way and will likely build understanding over the term, the year, or beyond.



Narrate

- Process the ideas of the lesson by retelling the events in sequence, describing a scene or setting, explaining a concept, etc.
- Learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.



Discuss

- Consider together any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage.
- Questions/topics for further discussion are often provided in the lesson plans to help. There are no right or wrong answers to these. If teachers want to keep ideas active in the mind, these can also be used at other times to keep the ideas in the working memory.



Connect

- Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, look at pictures, etc., depending on learner interest.
- These can also be viewed as alternative ways to engage.

Natural History: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 1

The Bumblebee

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on p.87. What do you notice, or what do you already know about the bumblebee? In our reading today, the author states that bumblebees are the only bee native to North America, but that's not quite true. They are the only social bee, but there are some 3600 other native North American bees! Let's read and try to learn something new about this one today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-90 "Sometimes" - "worker or queen."

- You may have read about or noticed before that some creatures depend on each other, like a butterfly and their host plants. Based on what you read, what other plants or animals could you say the bumblebee depends on? What plants or animals depend on the bumblebee?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Bumblebee in Slow Motion (1:40)

★ TEACHER NOTE

This author states that bumblebees are the only native bee in North America, but this is false. Teachers can strike the third sentence (if reading aloud) or advise students as noted in the introduction.

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 2

The Ladybug

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Recall what we read about the bumblebee. Look at the picture on p.91. What do you notice? What insect family do you think the ladybug belongs to?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-94 "Although there" - "outdoors again."

- Who in this chapter would you say is dependent on whom?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Ladybugs in Slow Motion (2:11)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 3

Aphids

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me about the ladybug and why everyone likes them so much. Today we read

★ TEACHER TIP

It can sometimes be unnerving for students to not get an immediate answer to a question, so encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.



Term 1

about those aphids.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.95-98 "Aphids are" - "by eating aphids."

- The author describes the problem of aphids harming plants, but everything has a purpose in Creation. Can you think of some reason to appreciate the aphid?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Aphids Close Up (0:44)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!

Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 4

The Lacewing

📖 Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last time. Look at the picture on p.99. You may have read a bit about the lacewing before, but have you ever seen one? Can you see why it is called the lacewing?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.99-101 "The lacewing" - "destroy aphids."

- Compare the lifecycle of the lacewing to that of the butterfly or beetle.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Green Lacewing Close Up (0:33)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!

Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 5

The Mosquito

📖 Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Can you recall 3 insects that you read about so far this term? Today, we are going to read about the mosquito. Look at the picture on p.102. What do you notice? What about the mosquito's life cycle is similar to or different from the other insects you know?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.102-106 "If one looks" - "in the spring."

- The author mentions that the development of the mosquito depends on the temperature, and you can see that they need water during the first 3 stages of their life cycle. Based on that information, where do you suppose mosquitoes would be more or less of a problem? You can use a map or globe for help, if you like.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Mosquito Close Up (0:24)

★ TEACHER TIP

If students have difficulty considering the discussion question because they have little awareness of climate in different places, that's okay! Show them on the globe that because the sun's light hits the equator directly, those places are hotter, whereas the poles are colder. Just let them hypothesize about where there might be more mosquitoes and leave it at that!

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!

Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 6

The Dragonfly and Damselfly

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember about the life cycle of the mosquito. Look at the picture on p.107. What do you notice or recall about the dragonfly?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.107-112 "Let us watch" - "do not hurt it."

- How do you think the weather and seasons affect the life cycle of the dragonfly?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Dragonfly or Damselfly? (0:55)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 7

The Tomato Hornworm

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me about 3 of the insects we have read about so far. Look at the picture on p.114. What stands out to you about this caterpillar?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-116 "If you have" - "full-grown."

- How are the tomato plant, the hornworm, and the parasitic wasp connected? Draw a diagram, called a food chain, if helpful. Who eats whom? What if something in the ecosystem changed and all of the parasitic wasps died? How do you think that would affect the other members of the food chain?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Hornworm Up Close (0:44)

★ TEACHER TIP

If students are interested in the idea of the food chain, teachers can add that many birds like to eat hornworms, too!

★ TEACHER TIP

If students need support drawing or diagramming, the teacher may do the activity with them in tandem or act as their scribe.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 8

The Hornworm Changes

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember about the hornworm. Today, let's read about its metamorphosis. What do you recall about metamorphosis?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.117-120 "When full-grown" - "tomato plants."

★ TEACHER TIP

Engage students in discussion to help them understand that the ecosystem is complex.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.



Term 1

- In what ways would you say that the creatures in this chapter are good or bad?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Sphinx Moth (1:04)

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 9

The Cecropia Moth

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Do you recall how the author said that moths are different from butterflies? Look at the picture on p.122-123 (it is also the picture on the cover). What do you notice about this Cecropia moth? You can continue looking at it while we read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.121-125 "The cecropia" - "to the twig."

- Cecropia lives in eastern North America, where there are hardwood trees, like maple. What would happen if something in the environment changed that caused the maple trees to die?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Image Link: University of Florida: Cecropia Stages

∞ Video Link: Cecropia Moth (0:27)

★ TEACHER TIP

Sometimes readings can seem harder to narrate when there are no events that fit together in sequence or when students are unable to create the image described in their mind. It can be helpful to draw during the reading or to provide an image, like the ones linked in this lesson, to which they can attach the ideas during the reading. They can then use the image, either from memory or by pointing to it, during their narration.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 10

The Caterpillar Changes

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Tell me what you recall about the Cecropia caterpillar and moth.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.126-128 "Soon the caterpillar" - "work is done."

- Cecropia moths emerge in the spring as the maples are growing their new leaves and flowers. How do you think the colors and patterns of this caterpillar and moth serve it?

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 11

The Isabella Tiger Moth

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Remind me what the hornworm and Cecropia caterpillar look like. Have you ever seen a fuzzy black and brown caterpillar? Do you know what kind of moth he becomes? Let's read about that one today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.129-132 "When one goes" - "eat them at night."

- How do you think the colors and patterns of this caterpillar and moth serve it? Make a food chain diagram for this creature. What if changes in the environment killed the clover and dandelion? What if changes killed the bats?

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 3

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Term 1		
	→ SUPPLEMENTAL ∞ Video Link: Isabella Tiger Moth (1:53)	
WEEK 12	10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4	• OUTDOOR WORK Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 3

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Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 13

The Quail

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on p.1. Have you ever seen a bird like this one before?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-4 "Did you ever" - "ice and snow."

- What can you tell about the quail's habitat from the reading? What living and non-living parts of the ecosystem do you think affect the quail most?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Bobwhite (a Quail)

★ TEACHER TIP

This passage calls attention to the uniqueness of birds' songs. Listening to recordings, like those found at the link, will help students learn to recognize and find the birds in nature. These links are provided for all of our birds this term. Teachers will find related species from other parts of the continent near the bottom of each page, and are encouraged to explore the images and audio for the species near them.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 14

The Brown Thrasher

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Tell me something that you recall about the quail. Today's bird is quite a bit smaller than the quail. Look at the picture on p.7. What stands out to you about the brown thrasher?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.6-11 "Listen to that" - "in the spring."

- Compare the brown thrasher and the quail. How are they alike and how are they different?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Brown Thrasher

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 15

The Cardinal

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Remind me who we have read about so far. Look at the picture on p.12. What do you notice about this bird?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.12-14 "Here is one" - "enemies of birds."

- How is the cardinal different from the quail and thrasher? How do you think cardinals' colors and patterns serve them? Do you think the cardinal is the "most interesting and attractive" bird? Why or why not?

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 3

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[scan the QR code](#)
[for links.](#)



Term 2

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Cardinal

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 16

The Purple Martin

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me something that you remember about the cardinal. Look at the picture on p.16-17. What stands out to you?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.16-19 "Did you ever" - "colony birdhouses."

- The author says that purple martins migrate in the fall so they can have plenty of food during winter. Explain what this means.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Purple Martin

★ TEACHER TIP

Help students understand that seasonal changes in the insect population force purple martins to migrate because of how they are designed to eat.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!
Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 17

The Kingbird

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last time. Today, we have another bird that eats on the wing. Look at the picture on p.20. What do you notice about this bird?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-22 "Have you ever" - "in the spring."

- The author states that we should protect the kingbird because 'it is so brave and so helpful to man.' What are other reasons you can think of why we should protect any creature?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Western Kingbird

★ TEACHER TIP

Help students to understand that we should protect all of God's creatures, whether we understand their purpose or not.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!
Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 18

The Crow

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me something that is similar and something that is different about the purple martin and the kingbird. How is the quail similar to and different from them? Look at the picture on p.23. Have you seen or heard a crow before?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23-25 "Caw! Caw!" - "are very wise."

★ TEACHER TIP

It can sometimes be unnerving for students not to get an immediate answer to a question, so encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily



Term 2

- Compare the crow and the purple martin. Why do you think the crow might not be as sensitive to changes in the ecosystem as the purple martin?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Crow

outdoor time are vital!
Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 19 *The Owl and Their Anatomy*

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last time. Look at the picture on p.26. Do you know who this is? How does this bird look different from the others you have read about? We can't see it in this picture, but the owl has very special feathers. Some people think they are like the soft, downy feathers that lie underneath and keep birds warm, but they are not. They have something more like fringes on the edges. Let's see what else we can learn about them in the reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.27-32 "Did you ever" - "from the perch."

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: The Silent Flight of Owls Explained

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Barred Owl

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Great Horned Owl

★ TEACHER NOTE

This author states that owls' feathers are tipped with down, but this is false according to the Audubon Society. If reading aloud, teachers can begin the third sentence of the second paragraph with "The owl has unique feathers, making their flight..." or advise students as noted in the introduction. The first link contains a photograph for those who are interested.
∞ Image Link: The Silent Flight of Owls Explained

★ TEACHER NOTE

This reading has two owls linked because the author describes the call of the barred owl, but the image is of the great horned owl, whose range is more widespread.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!
Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 20 *More About Owls and Their Nesting Habits*

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Tell me what you recall about the owl. Today, we'll read about how they raise their young.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-37 "Owls do much" - "to hunt."

- Why do you suppose that many large, predatory birds (raptors) nest in the winter? We always have to be very careful about interfering with wildlife because sometimes we can do harm without realizing it. What would you do if you found owlets, like the ones found by the men in the silo? Did you know that there are special people, called wildlife rehabilitators, who know how to take care of such animals?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Barred Owl Cam Highlights (5:00)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!
Resources in Quick Links.



Term 2

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 21

An Owl of Your Choice

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you recall about the owl. The book has many different kinds of owls in it, and you can read about any of them, but let's just choose one or two today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

selection from p.40-59

- How does the owl's color and pattern serve it? Do you think it is more sensitive to changes in the ecosystem, like the purple martin, or more adaptable, like the crow? Why?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Website Link: All About Birds Owl List

★ TEACHER TIP

Teachers may wish to select one or two owls from the variety based on those that are in their locale, or they may wish to let students select based on their interest.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 22

A Quiet Approach and Watching Hummingbirds

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Have you spent time watching birds? What would you say is the most important thing to do when watching them? Have you ever had a bird come up close to you? Let's find out what our book suggests.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.61-66 "Just think about" - "see hummingbirds."

- Show me how you would want to go bird watching, so that you don't scare away the birds.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Audio & Image Link: All About Birds: Ruby-throated Hummingbird

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 23

Look for Color, Beaks, Wings, and Tails

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

What are some of your favorite birds that you learned about this term? Tell me about how the mother hummingbird teaches her young to drink nectar. Let's read today about some interesting things to notice when bird watching.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.67-71 "When you want" - "on the ground."

- Have you noticed some of these features in birds you have seen or read about? How do you think each feature helped the bird to fit its purpose in the ecosystem?

★ TEACHER TIP

Encourage students to think of some examples from their observations to connect to the text.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.



Term 2

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 24
Exam Week

→ EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

• OUTDOOR WORK
Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital!
Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 25

Turtles

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Turtles and snakes are cousins in the reptile family. We'll read a bit about several different members in the family, starting today with the turtles. What do you know about turtles?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.137-139 "A turtle walks" - "walked away."

- What do you think turtles have in common with their reptile cousin, the snake? Draw or diagram the parts of the turtle discussed in the reading.

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

★ TEACHER TIP

If students need support drawing or diagramming, the teacher might do the activity with them in tandem or act as their scribe.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 26

More About Turtles

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember about turtles from the last passage. Today, let's find out about their young and what they eat.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.140-141 "A farmer noticed" - "to be quite old."

- Can you diagram a food chain for the turtle? What is missing from the reading? Who do you think preys on turtles?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note that many of the turtle passages in the Nature Reader comment about keeping these creatures as pets and about whether they are used for food. In many locations, it is now illegal to trap or keep them, however.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 27

Box and Painted Turtles

Materials: Links

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you recall so far about turtles. We'll read about two different kinds of turtles today, but these turtles aren't in our book. Have you seen or heard about the box turtle or the painted turtle? Why do you think they are called those names?

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: Museum of Discovery: Ornate Box Turtle

★ TEACHER TIP

Some of the lessons on reptiles require supplementation. In this lesson, read and narrate the two portions separately because they are on different, though related topics. Then discuss.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Wildlife Medical Clinic: Let's Paint a Story

- How are these two turtles similar and how are they different? How do you think their special features help them to fit their purpose in the ecosystem?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Eastern Box Turtle (1:49)

∞ Video Link: Western Painted Turtle (1:19)

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 28

Wood and Snapping Turtles

📄 Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Who were the two turtles we read about last time? We'll read about two more turtles today: the wood turtle and the alligator snapping turtle. Can you tell from their names what their habitats might be?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.142-143 "The wood turtle" - "vegetables and berries."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: NC Zoo: Oh Snap!

- How are these turtles similar and different? How do you think their special features help them to fit their purpose in the ecosystem?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Wood Turtle (1:28)

∞ Video Link: Snapping Turtle (0:33)

★ TEACHER TIP

Again in this lesson, read and narrate the two portions separately because they are on different, though related topics. Then discuss.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 29

Snakes

📄 Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

→ INTRO

Tell me about the last two turtles that we read about. Today, let's read about their reptile cousins, the snakes. What do you recall about snakes? Note that this author uses the term "poisonous" when the correct term is "venomous." A poison is something that is ingested; a venom is something that is injected.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.153-155 "If you are" - "the eggs whole."

- Draw or diagram the parts of the snake discussed in the reading. What makes a snake a reptile and not a mammal or a bird? What makes a snake a snake and not a turtle?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Image Link: Growing with Science: Snake Shed

∞ Video Link: Snake Up Close (1:54)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note that this author uses the term "poisonous" when the correct term is "venomous." A poison is something that is ingested; a venom is something that is injected.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.



Term 3

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 30

More About Snakes

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about in the last passage. We'll learn a bit more about snakes today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.156-158 "A poisonous snake" - "destroy many snakes."

- Draw or diagram a food chain for the snake, based on what you read. Does it intersect with other food chains that you know about? You could add them to this food chain and make it a food web!

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Image Link: Growing with Science: Snake with Full Belly

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 31

Venomous Snakes

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Some people think that snakes are scary. Why do you think that is? Tell me what you have learned about how snakes move along and about the venomous fangs that some have. Let's read about three kinds of venomous snakes today. In addition to rattlesnakes, these are all of the venomous snakes in North America. You should learn how to identify the ones near you at your local nature preserve or state park.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.162-167 "The copperhead" - "and birds' eggs."

- What do you do if you encounter a snake that you think might be venomous? What features could you look for to help you identify the snake without getting too close?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Rattlesnake Up Close (1:04)

★ TEACHER NOTE

It is best for students to learn to identify their local venomous snakes from a local nature preserve or state park.

★ TEACHER TIP

If students are not familiar with a "dumbbell" shape, then suggest a different image, such as an hourglass or Hershey's Kisses.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 32

Water Snakes

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4, article link

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you learned about venomous snakes. Let's take a closer look at some of North America's nonvenomous snakes, beginning with the water snake. While many different kinds of snakes like to swim, the water snake is a specific kind of snake. They are only native in the east, but are also found in the west, and so could really be found anywhere.

★ TEACHER TIP

Some of the lessons on reptiles require supplementation. In this lesson, read the very short passage from the text, followed by the article. Then narrate and discuss as a single topic.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.



Term 3

→ READ

p.169 "The water snake" - "by a bass."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Museum of Life and Science: Northern Water Snake

- How do you think the water would affect a snake's movement? How does it affect your movement when you swim or play in the water?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Common Water Snake (2:39)

WEEK 9

10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 33

King Snakes

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4, article link

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

What do you remember about water snakes? Let's read a little about king snakes today, of which there are many different cousins in the family all over North America. Why do you think they are called 'king'?

→ READ

p.170-171 "The king snake" - "bold and fearless."

∞ Image Link: Museum of Life and Science: Scales

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: National Park Service: Sierra Mountain Kingsnake

- This snake can take on many different colors and patterns, so what makes a king snake a king snake?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Image Link: National Park Service: The King of Snakes

★ TEACHER TIP

Again in this lesson, read the short passage from the text, followed by the article. Then narrate and discuss as a single topic. The link provided with the short passage in the reader is intended to help with the mention of smooth scales versus rigid scales. If this is not of interest, then the image is not necessary.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 10

10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 34

Garter Snakes

Materials: Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4, article link

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what we read about last time. One of the most common types of snakes in North America is the garter snake. This is another one that can be found in many different variations all over the continent and is one of the most commonly seen snakes.

→ READ

p.173 "The garter snake" - "on their own."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Ames Free Library: Common Garter Snake (from "Behind Queset Garden's reflecting pool")

- Snakes can sometimes appear to have striking colors and patterns, but then they

★ TEACHER TIP

Again in this lesson, read the short passage from the text, followed by the article. Then narrate and discuss as a single topic.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.



Term 3

seem to disappear in their natural habitat. What do you imagine a garter snake might appear to be in a forest or pond habitat?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Image Link: Audubon Portland: Patient of the Week

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 35

Bull Snakes

Materials: article link

→ INTRO

Remind me about garter snakes - what do you know about them? The last snake we'll learn about this term is the bull snake. It is an interesting snake that is more common in the western part of the continent. Its eastern cousin, called the pine snake, is important because it is endangered and many people don't know about it.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Bull Snake Encounter

- Many creatures use mimicry as a defense, like the bull snake mimicking a rattlesnake. Can you think of other creatures that you have learned about that mimic someone else in their biome?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Image Link: Smithsonian National Zoo: Northern Pine Snake

∞ Image Link: Museum of Natural Science: Pine Snake Nests

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 3 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4

★ TEACHER NOTE

Students may use other readings in the book not used in these lesson plans for extra reading practice, as appropriate!

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 3

Examination

- Term 1** · Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4: Draw or diagram one of the birds you saw or read about this term, showing how its body serves it in the ecosystem.
- Term 2** · Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4: Draw or diagram one of the birds you saw or read about this term, showing how its body serves it in the ecosystem.
- Term 3** · Christian Liberty Nature Reader 4: Draw or diagram one of the reptiles you saw or read about this term, showing how its body serves it in the ecosystem.